Winston Chou

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Employment

Netflix — New York, NY
Staff Research Scientist and Causal Inference Lead — 2022 – Present

- Designed the north-star metric used to decide personalization A/B tests at Netflix; Best Paper at KDD '25.
- Developed methodology and AI-assisted workflows for company-wide observational causal inference platform.
- Designed experiments to optimize Netflix's $15bn content budget; presented results to C- and VP-level execs.
- Promoted from Senior (L5) to Staff (L6) in 2024.

Apple — New York, NY
Staff Data Scientist — 2020 – 2022

- Designed, executed, and analyzed the first A/B tests on the Siri voice assistant.
- Wrote performant statistical software for analyzing experiments on 250m+ devices.
- Promoted from Senior (ICT4) to Staff (ICT5) in 2021.

Facebook / Meta — New York, NY
Research Scientist — 2018 – 2020

- Drove statistical models for imputing missing data in advertising measurement from R&D to launch.
- Partnered with product and engineering teams across ads, marketing science, and experimentation.

Education

Princeton University — Princeton, NJ
PhD, Political Science — 2019

Skills

- *Causal inference and experimentation.* Experiment design and analysis, experimentation platforms, meta-analysis, causal machine learning, observational causal inference, synthetic control, root cause analysis
- *Statistics and machine learning.* Regression analysis, hierarchical models, Bayesian statistics, maximum likelihood estimation, missing data, variance reduction, data visualization
- *Statistical computing.* Python, R, Spark, SQL, Stan, PyMC

Representative Research

[1] "A human-augmenting agentic workflow for observational causal inference," with Adrien Alexandre, Lars Olds, Yi Zhang, and Nathan Kallus. Under review. Netflix TechBlog post and open-source package.

[2] "The value of personalized recommendations: Evidence from Netflix," with Kevin Zielnicki, Guy Aridor, Aurélien Bibaut, Allen Tran, and Nathan Kallus. *International Journal of Industrial Organization*. Presented at *NBER Digital Economics and AI Meeting* and *ACM Conference on Economics and Computation '26*.

[3] "Estimating representative causal effects with double machine learning," with Apoorva Lal. *European Conference on Machine Learning & Principles and Practice of Knowledge Discovery in Databases (ECML PKDD '26).*

[4] "Blending proxy metrics with a north star." *ECML PKDD '26.*

[5] "Evaluating decision rules across many weak experiments," with Colin Gray, Nathan Kallus, Aurélien Bibaut, and Simon Ejdemyr. *KDD '25: Proceedings of the 31st ACM SIGKDD Conference on Knowledge Discovery and Data Mining.* **Best Paper Award (Applied Data Science).** Netflix TechBlog post.